

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Are you going out for dinner?



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in a range of social and work contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What is your favorite place in your local area?
- Why do you like it?

Can Do Statements

- I can make and respond to suggestions.
- I can interrupt someone, change and get back to a topic.
- I can talk about social activities.





Let's Explore!

Peter gives Miranda and Ferdinand **a general sense*** of what his mother likes. What do they suggest?

* To give someone "a general sense" of something means to give them an overview.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Mmm, smells like roasted espresso in here. Oh, does anyone know if there's still a coffee roasting workshop here? I was thinking of taking my mom and ...
- Miranda:** Er, well, I don't know her. But if ...
- Peter:** But you've heard us on the phone before.
- Miranda:** Anyway ... as I was saying, you did mention she likes jewelry. Why not take her to a jewelry making workshop?
- Peter:** That's not a bad idea. But I am really considering the coffee roasting workshop.
- Miranda:** Ok. Maybe if we get a general sense of her preferences we could help. Why don't you tell us about her?
- Peter:** She's just lovely. She likes browsing through second-hand bookstores, candle making, soap making. Lately, she's been into glassblowing.
- Miranda:** Sorry to interrupt, but what is that?
- Peter:** It's a technique that involves inflating molten glass into a bubble with the aid of a blowpipe.
- Ferdinand:** I don't mean to intrude, but ... Can I just jump in here for a minute? Peter, that sounds boring. How about taking her for dinner?
- Peter:** Oh no. She eats like a bird. Money and food would be wasted.
- Miranda:** I have it. I heard there's a workshop on jewelry making. You could take her there.
- Peter:** That's perfect. She loves jewelry.
- Miranda:** I suggest you register in advance.
- Ferdinand:** Sorry, but why don't you just cook her dinner then?
- Peter:** She's never liked my cooking.
- Miranda:** Going back to what I was saying, these workshops get booked up pretty quickly.
- Peter:** I'll keep that in mind. Thanks for the suggestions guys. See ya!



Let's Practice!

What do Miranda and Ferdinand suggest? How does Peter respond?

Instructions: Read the sentences. Choose them according to each category. Put them into each table. Practice saying the sentences aloud with a partner. Correct each other.

- I suggest you register in advance.
- Why not take her to a jewelry making workshop?
- Oh, well that could work.
- How about taking her out for dinner? I'll keep that in mind.
- Oh, no.
- Why don't you tell us about her?
- I like the sound of that.
- You could take her to that workshop.
- Thanks for the suggestions.
- That's not a bad idea.
- That's perfect.
- I was thinking of taking my mom to that workshop.
- Maybe if we get a general sense of her preferences we could help.

Making Suggestions

Responding to Suggestions



Let's Practice!

Peter wants to get back to the topic.

Instructions: Proofread the sentence. Circle the incorrect word. Write the sentences correctly. Use capital letters where necessary. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Wow, does anyone know if there's a coffee roasting workshop here?

2. Ears, dull, I don't know her.

3. That you've heard us on the phone before.

4. Well ... what you had said, you did mention she likes jewelry.

5. Sorry to consider , but what is that?

6. I don't want to interrupt, but ... Can I just skip in here for a minute?



Extension Activity

What's your favorite activity?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a list of your social activities (about 3 to 5) you like to do in your area, neighborhood or workplace.
- Write one or two things you like about each activity.
- Have a conversation with your partner and suggest an activity to do after school or work.
- Interrupt your partner and suggest another activity.
- Make sure you interrupt, change the topic, and suggest a few different activities.
- When you are finished, switch roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I have a conversation about my favorite activities.

☐ ☐

I politely interrupt during a conversation.

☐ ☐

I make and respond to suggestions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- glassblowing** (noun): the process of making glass by blowing air through a tube
e.g. Lately, she's been into glassblowing.
- coffee roasting** (noun): the process of cooking coffee beans
e.g. Is there still a coffee roasting workshop here?
- jewelry making** (noun): the process of assembling and forming jewelry by hand
e.g. Why not take her to a jewelry making session?
- to browse through** (verb): to scan through something to get an idea of what it includes
e.g. She likes browsing through second-hand bookstores.
- candle making** (noun): the process of creating a candle using wax
e.g. I prefer candle making over jewelry making.
- soap making** (noun): the process of producing a bar of soap
e.g. My mom enjoys soap making in her spare time.





Learning Points

Making and Responding to Suggestions

Sometimes you have an idea, a recommendation or plan that you think could work for your company. It is important to use proper language to offer those ideas for someone to consider. Here is some language you can use for making and responding to recommendations.

Making Suggestions/Recommendations	Responding to Suggestions/Recommendations
You could ... (+verb) You might want to ... (+verb) Why not ... (+verb) Why don't you ... (+verb) How about ... (-ing)	That's not a bad idea. Exactly. I like the sound of that. Oh, well ... Oh no.

Examples:

- *Hey, do you know of a nice restaurant around here?*
- *Well, how about going to Joint Tea?*
- *That's a good idea, thanks!*





Learning Points

Interrupting, Changing and Getting Back to a Topic

In English, sometimes we need to interrupt people. This can be because we need to say something, express our opinion, or make a suggestion.

In a conversation, interruptions are acceptable and perfectly normal if done appropriately. You will also need to interrupt and change topics. Once the other person has stopped speaking, you will need to return to the topic you were previously talking about. Here are some common ways you can do them:

Interrupting	Changing the topic	Returning to the topic
• Sorry but ... (+ clause) • Er, well ... (+clause) • Excuse me, but ... (+clause) • Can I just say something? • Well, ... (+clause) • I don't mean to intrude but ... • Can I just jump in here for a minute?	• Speaking of ... • By the way, ... • Talking of ... • That reminds me ... • Speaking of which ...	• As I was saying ... • Anyway, ... • Going back to what I was saying ...

Examples:

- *I want to take my mother to a nice restaurant. I was thinking ...*
- **Sorry, but** *why don't you just cook her a meal?*
- *Not sure it's a good idea. **Anyway, as I was saying,** I want to take her out.*

